

About the Name

וַאֲמַר מָה אֵלֶּה אֲדֹנָי וַיֹּאמֶר אֵלֵי הַמַּלְאָךְ הַדֹּבֵר בִּי אֲנִי אֶרְאֶךָ מָה הֵמָּה אֵלֶּה (זכריה א:ט)

“I said, ‘What are these, my Lord?’ The angel **who was speaking to me** said to me, ‘I will show you what these are.’”

The name **הַדֹּבֵר בִּי** was chosen for Zeidy’s sefer with great thought and care, for it is deeply meaningful and carries layers of significance.

Firstly, the word **בִּי** corresponds to the initials of Zeidy’s name: **יששכר בנימין**. The fact that the order of the letters is reversed - from **יב** to **בי** - follows the example of Zeidy’s revered Rav, R’ Noach Isaac Oelbaum, who employed a similar reversal in naming his own sefer **הַדֹּבֵר בִּי** (נה for חן).

Secondly, the word **הַדֹּבֵר** contains the same letters as Bobbi’s name, **דברה**. This connection beautifully reflects the principle of **אשתו כגופו**, emphasizing the unity and partnership of Zeidy and Bobbi in their life’s mission. Their mutual dedication to **תורה**, family, and **חסד** is woven into the very fabric of this sefer, reflecting their shared legacy.

Most fundamentally, the phrase **הַדֹּבֵר בִּי**, and the **פסוק** in which it is written, encapsulates the essence of this sefer. It signifies the act of communication, of transmitting wisdom, which is the very foundation of the **תורה** and its perpetuation through the generations. The **pasuk** describes the interaction between a questioner and a teacher - the child and the parent, the student and the guide: “I asked the **מַלְאָךְ**, ‘What is this?’ and the **מַלְאָךְ** answered, ‘I will show you.’” This model of **חינוך**, of children asking questions and receiving answers from their parents, is precisely the dynamic that this sefer seeks to preserve. Zeidy’s **דברי תורה** represent his role as a teacher, lovingly responding to the questions of the next generation. Moreover, viewing Zeidy as the “**מַלְאָךְ**” in this **pasuk** feels natural, as anyone who knows him recognizes his sterling **מידות** and unwavering **צידיקות**. The title **הַדֹּבֵר בִּי** elevates this sefer as a channel for Zeidy’s voice, his **תורה**, and his love for his family and **ישראל**.

And finally, one last reason why this title is so fitting: the **gematria** of **הַדֹּבֵר בִּי** is the same as **ארי**.